

Ohio River Trail Council



Ohio is an Iroquois Indian name, "Oheo" which traditionally is interpreted to mean "Beautiful River," agreeing with the French explorer Rene Robert Cavelier Sieur de La Salle who was so taken with the Ohio River when he first laid eyes on it in 1669 that he christened it "La Belle Riviere." The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is a pioneering organization composed of a dedicated and visionary leadership to develop strategies on how to implement our vision of building better communities through the restoration of the magnificent Ohio River. The Ohio River Trail Council is in full support of the ORSANCO Ohio River Sweep Program and encourages all ORTC partner communities to participate.

Ohio River Sweep Program

The River Sweep is an annual cleanup for the Ohio River and its tributaries. The event encompasses more than 3,000 miles of shoreline from Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania to Cairo, Illinois. Since 1989, this award-winning cleanup for the Ohio River and its tributaries brings thousands of volunteers to the riverbanks to collect tons of trash and debris.

More than 21,000 volunteers from public organizations, civic groups, recreational clubs, and the general public in six states bordering the river come together to collect more than 20,000 tons of trash and other debris from the banks of the Ohio River and tributaries.

River Sweep is an event organized by the Ohio River Valley Water Sanitation Commission, an interstate water pollution agency for the Ohio River Valley, along with environmental protection and natural resource agencies from Illinois, Indiana, Ohio, Kentucky, West Virginia, and Pennsylvania.

"The Ohio River Sweep is very important because for a few hours on one day volunteers can help make a difference in the appearance of this great natural resource," said Jeanne Ison, Project Director. "The Sweep has grown so much in the past few years, we've been able to expand the project to tributaries and feeder streams of the Ohio River."



FAQ's

When is the River Sweep event?

The River Sweep is an annual cleanup event held each year on the third Saturday in June. Improvements in river water quality have caused an increase in the recreational use of the river. This increase has led to more litter on the riverbanks. Thus, a yearly cleanup program is needed to keep the river suitable for public use. In addition to keeping the riverbanks clean, ORSANCO hopes that increased public exposure to the river will foster greater environmental concern for it in the future.

Who should participate?

Anyone wanting to make a difference in the quality of the Ohio River should participate. The River Sweep provides an excellent opportunity for many civic groups, school organizations, and recreational clubs to actively participate in a community service event. Any individual, young or old, or any group is welcome. Children under 18 need a parent signature on the liability waiver before participating.

What will I gain from participating in the Sweep?

You will play an active role in improving your environment. You also will be part of a very unique experience - the river-long Sweep is one of the largest cleanup events of its kind in the United States.

What happens to trash collected from the riverbanks?

All trash is either recycled or disposed of in an environmentally acceptable manner.

Are there designated cleanup sites on the river?

Yes. There will be at least one designated cleanup area for each of the counties bordering the river, plus additional sites along tributaries. Areas will be chosen according to the amount of litter on the site and accessibility to volunteers. Marinas and boat ramps typically make good cleanup areas.

What should I wear and/or bring to the River Sweep?

Wear old, comfortable clothes and shoes or boots that you won't mind getting dirty. Close-toed shoes are also recommended. Trash bags and gloves will be

provided.

Is there danger involved?

River Sweep can be a fun day, filled with good company and the knowledge that the river will be cleaner from your efforts. However, you should keep a few things in mind to keep the event free of accidents:

- Watch where you walk and avoid broken glass, rusty nails, and poison ivy.
- Always wear gloves.
- Never place yourself in a dangerous situation, such as trying to get trash floating in the river.
- Don't get in the water.
- Stay away from thick, brushy areas.
- Avoid high cliffs.
- Watch for traffic when working in a pull-over area along the side of the road.
- Volunteers must sign a waiver of liability, and anyone under 18 years old must have parental permission to participate. An on-site supervisor will be available.

[River Sweep Volunteer Waiver 2012](#)

[River Sweep Brochure 2012](#)

[Source: ORSANCO](#)

It's time for the annual cleaning of the Ohio River Watershed and the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is requesting your support. Volunteers are needed for a River Sweep along the shoreline of the Ohio River and its tributaries.

Please be advised that cleanup sites events may be rescheduled or postponed due to high river levels, so please check with the River Sweep coordinator for your area before attending.

When?

Date: Saturday, June 16, 2012 One Day Only!

Time: 8:30 am - Noon.

Where? The following Pennsylvania cleanup sites along the proposed Ohio River Trail corridor have been confirmed.

Monaca Pumphouse Park - GPS 40.694265,-80.284374

Contact: John DiMarzio

RSVP Email - john.dimarzio@gmail.com:

RSVP Phone - 724-775-9600
Address- 6th Street & Atlantic Av
Directions: Meet at the main park pavilion.

Shippingport Boat Dock GPS 40.629195,-80.426252
Meet at the boat dock area near Ferry Rd and the power plants.

New Brighton
Contact: Keith McKeel
RSVP Email - nbstp@newbrightonborough.org
RSVP Phone - 724-624-4962

New Brighton Blockhouse Run North
Directions: Off Rt. 18 opposite side of Rt. 18 from New Brighton Sewage Treatment Plant, meet where Third Avenue ends.

New Brighton Blockhouse Run
Directions: Meet at New Brighton Middle School parking lot.

Coraopolis/[Groveton Boat Club](#) GPS: 40.512543,-80.145178
Contact: Geri Morgan
RSVP Phone - 412-264-6776
Address - Royal Avenue End, P.O. Box 284, Coraopolis, PA 15108
Directions: From Coraopolis, take Rt. 51 South. Turn left onto Lewis Avenue at end of small bridge. Go straight through stop sign (road turns into Elizabeth Street). Turn right past light blue building (boat dock sign). Cross railroad tracks and turn left. Groveton Boat Club is on right side.

From McKees Rocks, take Rt. 51 north 3/10 mile past I-79 exit. Turn right onto Pittsburgh Avenue (past Walden Activity Center), then turn right again onto Lewis Avenue. Follow Lewis Avenue (go straight at stop sign). Lewis turns into Elizabeth Street. Turn right past light blue building (boat dock sign). Cross railroad tracks and turn left. Groveton Boat Club is on the right.

From I-79 north to Coraopolis/McKees Rocks exit. Turn left onto Rt. 51, then turn right onto Pittsburgh Avenue past Walden Activity Center then again onto Lewis Avenue (go straight at stop sign). Lewis turns into Elizabeth Street. Turn right past light blue building (boat dock sign). Cross railroad tracks and turn left. Groveton Boat club is on the right side.

Leetsdale Fish & Boat Commission Boat Ramp
Contact: Mayor Pete Poninsky
RSVP - 724-624-4521
RSVP Email: mayorpete@leetsdaleboro.net
Time - 10 am - Noon
Directions: From Pittsburgh, take Rt. 65 North approximately 2.5 miles past the Sewickley Bridge, turn left onto Ferry Street (1 stoplight past Quaker Village Shopping Center). Cross railroad tracks and turn right onto First Street (First Street turns into Washington). Go one mile and turn left onto Petrun Road.

Launch is at end of road.

Crescent / Glenwillard Boat Club GPS: 40.556363,-80.21822

Contact: Jim Burgunder

RSVP Phone - 724-272-1777

Address - 400-448 Ferry St, Crescent, Pennsylvania 15046

Directions: From Airport, take Beers School / Narrows Run Road from Airport - turn left onto Rt. 51 North at light. Follow Rt. 51 North to Glenwillard. Turn right at Riverview Road (by stone monument and across from Crescent Township Volunteer Co.). Go 1/10th mile and turn left under tunnel. Turn right at end of tunnel into boat club.

From North, take Rt. 51 South to Glenwillard. Turn left onto Riverview Road (by stone monument). Go 1/10th mile and turn left under tunnel. Turn right at end of tunnel into boat club.

To locate the site(s) for your county, click [here](#), call 1-800-359-3977 or contact the ORSANCO Public Information Department. For more information, please call Jeanne Ison at 1-800-359-3977 or Betsy Mallison at (412) 735-1258

Ohio River Trail Council

The Ohio River Trail Council's mission is to honor our past and build our future by providing recreation opportunities, heritage development, environmental stewardship, safe transportation networks and economic stimulus. Our goal is to promote and protect a continuous corridor of natural and cultural resources along the Ohio River and its tributaries to ensure these assets and resources remain accessible for future generations.

In Pennsylvania, the Ohio River Trail Council is currently planning & developing a 41-mile bike and water trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the Ohio River, from Coraopolis, Pa (near Pittsburgh) to Ohioville, Pa. (near East Liverpool, OH). The *Ohio River Trail* is part of the Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area, Lewis & Clark Trail and is a candidate for part of the U.S. Bicycle Route 50, Pittsburgh to Cleveland Trail, and a portion of the Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh spur. The proposed *Ohio River Trail* will also follow parts of the "Great Path" and the Lincoln Highway. The *Ohio River Trail* will serve as a key segment in the interconnection of existing land trails in the quad-state area (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia). Specifically, the proposed Ohio River Trail will connect the Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway in Columbiana County, Ohio to the Great Allegheny Passage in



Allegheny, County Pennsylvania forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol.

Donations

The Ohio River Trail Council cordially invites you to become a friend, a volunteer or a partner of our organization. The Ohio River Trail Council membership plays an integral part in promoting the vital role we perform in our region. The Ohio River Trail Council is a 501 (C) (3) non-profit organization, therefore your cash and property donations to the Ohio River Trail Council are tax deductible. The Ohio River Trail Council is an organization committed to excellence, with a clear vision and a passion for delivering outstanding results. We ask you to form an alliance with us to capitalize on our strengths in order to guarantee a bright future for our rivers, forests, and towns. Please visit www.ohiorivertrail.org for additional information and a [donation form](#).



Membership

To join the Ohio River Trail Council please download a [membership application](#) and mail your contribution to the ORTC office. Feel free to forward this message to a friend.



Correspondence

Please visit our [website](#) and [register](#) to receive ORTC correspondence. Thank you for your support.



For questions and comments please contact:

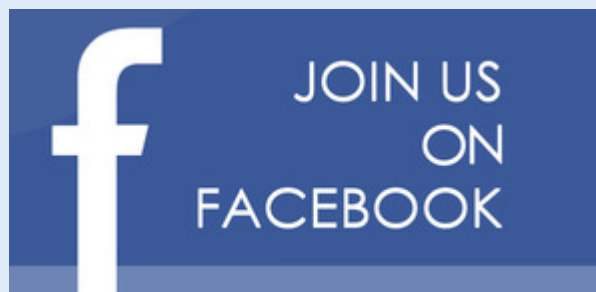
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